

Ransomware toolkit Cryptonite's variant turns into a data wiper

Due to its “poor design and programming,” a variant of the open source Cryptonite ransomware toolkit has been seen in the wild with data wiper capabilities. The original source code and its branches were later removed. Cryptonite was previously distributed for free through a GitHub repository by an individual going by the moniker of CYBERDEVILZ. Written in Python, it uses the Fernet module of the cryptography package to encrypt files with the ‘.cryptn8’ extension.

A fresh sample examined by Fortinet FortiGuard Labs was discovered to encrypt files and lock them without allowing for their decryption, basically acting as a harmful data wiper.

The program’s exception-throwing behaviour also prevents operators from ever receiving the ‘key’ that was used to encrypt the files, denying them access to their data. The discoveries are set against a backdrop of a changing ransomware landscape where wipers disguising themselves as malware that encrypt files are being used more frequently to destroy data without allowing for decryption.



“The problem with this flaw is that due to the design simplicity of the ransomware if the program crashes — or is even closed — there is no way to recover the encrypted files,” Fortinet researcher Gergely Revay said.



open source operating systems. Even though ClamAV isn’t the most widely used anti-virus program for any Microsoft operating system, it is now compatible with Windows as of version 0.97.5.

ClamAV has a number of sophisticated and complex anti-virus features, including multi-threaded parallel scans, built-in support for all common mail file formats, Elf (Linux) executables, and popular document formats, as well as the ability to monitor specific folders and directories for changes.

Since ClamAV is an open source project run by volunteers with a small team of paid engineers, it is difficult to compare it to anti-virus software sold in stores.

CI Fuzz CLI checks Java programs for vulnerabilities

Java developers can now simply integrate fuzz testing into their current JUnit setup to uncover functional defects and security vulnerabilities at scale with Code Intelligence’s open source CI Fuzz CLI tool.



The GitHub-hosted CI Fuzz CLI uses evolutionary techniques, automated instrumentation, and millions of unique inputs to test Java programs for unexpected behaviours that could result in crashes, denial-of-service attacks, or zero-day exploits. The open source community is becoming more and more interested in fuzz testing, which can be thought of as a complimentary method to unit testing. Fuzz testing was used by Google’s Open-Source-Security (OSS) team to find more than 40,500 problems in 650 open source projects. The majority of developers outside the OSS and security communities are still learning about fuzz testing, though.